that can lift one up from confusion, misery, melancholy and failure, and guide one to one's true place. And once an individual severs his emotional and physical bondage, he is on the road to freedom, happiness and peace of mind.

I was about six years old when my father embarked on the project of building a wooden sailboat to take pilgrims from Rameswaram to Dhanuskodi, (also cal ed Sethukkarai), and back. He worked at building the boat on the seashore, with the help of a relative, Ahmed Jal aluddin, who later married my sister, Zohara. I watched the boat take shape. The wooden hul and bulkheads were seasoned with the heat from wood fires. My father was doing good business with the boat when, one day, a cyclone bringing winds of over 100 miles per hour carried away our boat, along with some of the landmass of Sethukkarai. The Pamban Bridge col apsed with a train ful of passengers on it. Until then, I had only seen the beauty of